

# Kisir - Turkish Bulgur Salad

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## INGREDIENTS

2 cups fine or extra fine bulgur  
2 cups boiling water, plus more if needed  
3 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil, plus more for drizzling  
1/4 cup tomato paste  
3 tablespoons Turkish red pepper paste  
1 teaspoon Urfa pepper or red pepper flakes  
1/2 teaspoon ground cumin  
Kosher salt  
2 tablespoons pomegranate molasses  
1/2 lemon, juiced  
6 green onions  
3 ripe but firm Roma tomatoes  
1 cup chopped fresh parsley, plus more for garnish

## METHOD

- 1. Prepare the bulgur:** Place **1/2 cup of bulgur** in a mixing bowl. Pour in **1 cup of boiling water**, stirring gently to help absorption. Add just enough additional boiling water to cover the grains, then cover the bowl and let it sit until the bulgur is tender and has absorbed all liquid—about 15 minutes.
- 2. Make the flavorful paste:** Heat a small pan over medium heat and warm **olive oil** with **tomato paste, Turkish pepper paste, Urfa Biber**, cumin, and a **generous pinch of salt**. Stir until the pastes are fully melted and blended into a fragrant mixture.
- 3. Combine the flavors:** Pour the warmed paste mixture over the bulgur, then drizzle in **pomegranate molasses, fresh lemon juice**, and a little more olive oil. Mix thoroughly—traditionally, this step is done by kneading with gloved hands to fully coat the bulgur in the paste.
- 4. Cool and prep:** Transfer the bulgur mixture to the refrigerator to cool while you prepare the remaining ingredients.
- 5. Chop the vegetables and herbs:** Trim and finely chop **green onions** (both white and green parts). Dice **ripe tomatoes**, ensuring they aren't overly watery—if needed, halve them and squeeze out the seeds before chopping.
- 6. Assemble the salad:** Once the bulgur is fully cooled, fold in the chopped **green onions, tomatoes**, and **fresh parsley\*\***. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed.
- 7. Finish and serve:** Garnish generously with **more fresh parsley** and serve immediately.

THE  
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef